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Project Idea: AI Contract Risk Analyzer is an intelligent web-based platform that helps long-term freelancers, contract-based commercial talents, small business owners, agency founders, and corporate operations managers review legal contracts, detect high-risk clauses, estimate potential financial impact, and generate ready-to-send negotiation messages before signing.

Lab Objectives:

- Identify target users for the software project
- Develop realistic user personas
- Map personas to software requirements
- Apply user-centered design thinking

Part 1: Identify User Groups

Task: List all potential user groups of your system.

Deliverable:

User Group	Role	Frequency of Use	Technical Level
Long-term freelancers	Review recurring retainers, ongoing scope modifications, and contract termination notice windows	Monthly or ongoing	Medium
Commercial talents	Review single-gig agreements, one-off deliverable scopes, milestone payouts, and IP handover (strictly one-time jobs, no long-term commitment)	Per gig / One-off	Medium
Small business owners	Review supplier, vendor, and procurement agreements to avoid costly penalties	Weekly or monthly	Medium
Agency founders	Review client master service agreements (MSAs) and uncapped liability terms	Weekly	High
Commercial tenants	Review commercial lease agreements, renewal terms, and penalty clauses	Occasionally	Low to medium
Operations managers	Screen routine vendor agreements before legal escalation	Monthly	Medium

Part 2: Persona Creation

Create 2–4 personas using the following template:

Persona 1: Sara Al Harbi — Commercial Talent (Graphic Designer)

Attribute	Details	Issue Recap / Core Takeaway
Job Title	Talent	Hired for one-off deliverables; no retainer or long-term safety net
Age	27	Independent creative taking fixed single-job commercial gigs
Education	Bachelor's degree in Graphic Design	Non-legal background; intimidated by dense legal clauses
Role	Commercial talent signing project-based gig contracts with clients	High risk of endless revisions and unpaid IP transfer after delivery
Goals	Detect payment milestone risks, IP release conditions, and revision caps on single gigs	Needs ironclad assurance that copyright stays hers until full payout
Motivations	Protect gig earnings, prevent unpaid work, and negotiate amicably	Wants fair gig terms without risking immediate project cancellation
Pain Points	Complex legal text, pressure to sign fast, vague milestone acceptance criteria	Unsure what exact legal wording to ask for in counter-offers
Technical Skill	Medium (comfortable with creative web apps, no legal training)	Needs an intuitive UI with zero technical or legal barrier
Usage Context	Uses phone or laptop before each new gig to upload and verify PDFs	Requires immediate clause extraction and redline suggestions

Persona 2: Omar Al Qahtani — Small Business Owner

Attribute	Details	Issue Recap / Core Takeaway
Job Title	Owner	Sole bearer of business financial and operational liabilities
Age	39	Experienced commercial manager with limited legal time
Education	Bachelor's degree in Business Administration	Understands business metrics but lacks contract law expertise
Role	Owner of a coffee-supply business signing vendor/service agreements	Frequently signs recurring, high-value supplier agreements
Goals	Compare vendor contracts, detect auto-renewals, and check liability limits	Must eliminate recurring surprise fees and early-exit penalties
Motivations	Control overhead, safeguard cash flow, make fast decisions without lawyers	Needs rapid, cost-effective risk analysis for routine contracts
Pain Points	Lengthy agreements, costly legal fees, obscure worst-case clauses	High financial exposure buried in boilerplate legal sections
Technical Skill	Medium (regularly uses business software, prefers simple dashboards)	Prefers concise executive summaries and visual financial metrics
Usage Context	Uses office laptop weekly/monthly to review PDFs from suppliers	High-volume PDF reviews needing monetary risk rankings

Persona 3: Tariq Al Mansoor — Boutique Agency Founder

Attribute	Details	Issue Recap / Core Takeaway
Job Title	Founder	Responsible for agency growth, IP assets, and legal safety
Age	32	Tech-savvy founder managing multi-stakeholder enterprise deals
Education	Bachelor's degree in Computer Science	Deep technical fluency; values automated workflows and speed
Role	Founder of a boutique digital agency signing enterprise service contracts	Negotiates complex MSAs, SOWs, and SLA commitments
Goals	Screen contracts for uncapped liability, IP exposure, and strict indemnity	Must safeguard codebase ownership and avoid unlimited damages
Motivations	Safeguard agency IP, prevent scope creep, and accelerate deal closures	Seeks to shorten enterprise sales cycles without legal bottlenecks
Pain Points	Slow manual reviews, hidden liability in boilerplate, lawyer turnaround delays	Slow legal reviews stall enterprise client onboarding
Technical Skill	High (accustomed to developer tools, APIs, and enterprise SaaS suites)	Expects exportable audit reports, custom rules, and fast web UI
Usage Context	Uses workstation weekly to upload MSAs and review redline summaries	Seamless fit into agency deal-closing and contract review meetings

Persona 4: Noura Al Ghamdi — Corporate Operations Manager

Attribute	Details	Issue Recap / Core Takeaway
Job Title	Manager	Accountable for routine vendor compliance and operational continuity
Age	36	Senior enterprise operator coordinating multi-department vendors
Education	Bachelor's degree in Industrial Engineering	Process-oriented thinker focused on SLAs and contract turnaround speed
Role	Operations manager managing logistics, facilities, and IT vendor agreements	Processes recurring medium-value contracts requiring fast clearance
Goals	Screen routine vendor SLAs, detect non-standard penalty terms, and triage risk	Needs to prevent operational bottlenecks caused by legal team backlogs
Motivations	Speed up procurement cycles, protect company standards, and cut legal backlog	Wants an automated first-line review to escalate only genuine legal risks
Pain Points	Internal legal counsel takes 1–2 weeks per contract; reviewing terms manually is tedious	Contract delays stall urgent operational and equipment rollouts
Technical Skill	High (proficient in ERP platforms, enterprise workflows, and digital docs)	Requires batch-processing capabilities and clear compliance checklists
Usage Context	Uses office workstation weekly to batch-upload vendor agreements for triage	Needs quick redline summaries before sending agreements to legal

Part 3: Persona to Requirements Mapping

Map each persona to required system features.

Persona	Feature Needed	Priority
Sara Al Harbi (Talent)	Plain-language clause risk explanations and visual severity indicators	High
Sara Al Harbi (Talent)	Safer clause wording and a ready-to-send negotiation message generator	High
Sara Al Harbi (Talent)	Single-gig conditional IP transfer checker (retaining ownership until full payment)	Medium
Omar Al Qahtani (Owner)	Counterparty role perspective selection (Buyer vs. Seller risk evaluation)	High
Omar Al Qahtani (Owner)	Financial exposure ranking (money at stake calculation per clause)	High
Omar Al Qahtani (Owner)	Multi-agreement clause comparison dashboard	Medium
Tariq Al Mansoor (Founder)	Uncapped liability and mutual indemnification risk detector	High
Tariq Al Mansoor (Founder)	Exportable contract risk audit summary report (PDF / Word)	High
Tariq Al Mansoor (Founder)	Custom risk threshold configuration for agency legal standards	Medium
Noura Al Ghamdi (Manager)	Automated SLA compliance checklist and non-standard clause detector	High
Noura Al Ghamdi (Manager)	Batch document upload and rapid triage risk dashboard	High
Noura Al Ghamdi (Manager)	Legal escalation summary report with highlighted flagged clauses	Medium

Part 4: Scenarios & User Stories

Write:

- One usage scenario per persona
- Two user stories per persona

User Story Format: As a [persona], I want to [goal] so that [benefit].

1. Sara Al Harbi — Commercial Talent (Graphic Designer)

Usage scenario: Sara receives a PDF agreement from a corporate client for a one-off brand identity package (a single milestone-based gig, not an ongoing retainer). She uploads the contract and selects “Commercial Talent” as her role. The platform immediately flags an unconstrained revision clause and an unfair copyright assignment clause transferring ownership before final payment. Sara reviews the breakdown, copies the system-generated diplomatic counter-offer proposing a 2-round revision cap and conditional IP handover, and sends it to the client.

- **As a** commercial talent, **I want** the system to identify milestone payment and copyright assignment risks on single gigs **so that** I retain ownership of my deliverables until payment clears.
- **As a** commercial talent, **I want** pre-drafted polite negotiation messages with balanced substitute wording **so that** I can negotiate revision caps and milestone rules without risking gig cancellation.

2. Omar Al Qahtani — Owner (Small Business)

Usage scenario: Omar receives a supplier agreement for his business. He uploads the PDF and selects Buyer as his position. The analyzer ranks an automatic-renewal clause, an early-cancellation penalty, and an asymmetric liability clause by severity and estimated money at stake, allowing him to address the largest financial risk first and renegotiate terms before signing.

- **As a** small-business owner, **I want** risks ranked by estimated money at stake **so that** I can focus on the clauses that carry the highest financial exposure.
- **As a** small-business owner, **I want** the analysis tailored to my role as a buyer **so that** the recommendations align directly with my operational responsibilities.

3. Tariq Al Mansoor — Founder (Boutique Agency)

Usage scenario: Tariq prepares to finalize an enterprise client MSA. He uploads the document into the platform. The analyzer flags an uncapped consequential damages clause and an ambiguous post-termination non-compete clause. Tariq exports a clean risk summary audit report and reviews the suggested substitute language during his executive meeting before sending redlines to the client.

- **As an** agency founder, **I want** to detect uncapped liability and indemnification risks **so that** my agency avoids disproportionate legal exposure.
- **As an** agency founder, **I want** to export a structured contract risk audit report **so that** our leadership team can systematically evaluate and redline terms with the client.

4. Noura Al Ghamdi — Manager (Corporate Operations)

Usage scenario: Noura receives three incoming facilities and logistics maintenance agreements from new service providers. She uploads all three PDFs into the batch analyzer. Within minutes, the system highlights that one contract contains an irregular annual 15% price escalation clause and an unstandardized 90-day termination notice. Noura generates a one-page legal escalation summary flagging these two specific clauses, bypassing delay on the standard agreements while routing the flagged contract directly to internal counsel.

- **As an** operations manager, **I want** automated SLA and non-standard clause detection **so that** I can clear routine vendor contracts faster and avoid operational delays.
- **As an** operations manager, **I want** a legal escalation summary with flagged high-risk terms **so that** our in-house legal counsel only spends time reviewing contracts with genuine risks.

Submission:

- Personas (2–4)

- Persona-feature mapping
- User stories

Assessment Criteria:

Criterion	Marks
Persona realism & clarity	30%
Alignment with project idea	30%
Requirements mapping	20%
Scenarios & user stories	20%